

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Becoming A Musician

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	One speaker thinks being a musician could be _____ if a person became very successful.
2	The programme hears from people in the UK who want to become _____.
3	Bailey grew up in a _____ in St Ives.
4	From around age 11, she attended _____.
5	After school on Fridays, she went to _____.
6	Music from the 1970s had a strong _____ on Bailey.
7	Older musicians gave Bailey protection and _____.
8	Josh learned his first proper guitar song when he was _____.
9	A busker performs in public places to _____.
10	Busking helped Josh get opportunities, including all his _____ and connections.

11 **Why does Pippa hesitate about becoming a musician?**

- A She dislikes listening to music
- B She thinks musicians rarely have fans
- C She believes success could bring stress
- D She has never met a musician

12 **What question is the programme trying to explore?**

- A What life is like for people trying to become musicians
- B Which instrument is easiest for beginners
- C Why UK charts are no longer important
- D How to record music in a studio

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What early musical experience did Bailey have?**
- A She studied only classical music at school
 - B She avoided performing until adulthood
 - C She grew up without local music events
 - D She attended open mic events from about age eleven
- 14 **What do the older musicians and 1970s songs help explain about Bailey?**
- A Why she stopped writing music
 - B How her musical taste and development were shaped
 - C Why she moved away from St Ives
 - D How she became the oldest person in the group
- 15 **What are songwriters' circles?**
- A Meetings for people interested in writing music
 - B Paid concerts for famous artists only
 - C Competitions for chart positions
 - D Lessons about music marketing
- 16 **What does "took me under their wing" imply in Bailey's case?**
- A They ignored her because she was young
 - B They forced her to copy their songs
 - C They prevented her from performing publicly
 - D They offered her support and guidance
- 17 **What did Josh do soon after learning his first proper guitar song?**
- A He joined a famous band
 - B He started busking
 - C He stopped playing guitar
 - D He moved out of London
- 18 **What is a busker?**
- A A person who writes music reviews
 - B A musician who performs only online
 - C Someone who performs in public places for money
 - D A manager who organises concerts

19 **How has busking helped Josh?**

- A It has provided income, gigs and connections
- B It has stopped him from performing to people
- C It has replaced all his interest in music
- D It has made him avoid new opportunities

20 **What broader point does Josh's story suggest?**

- A Street performance has no value for musicians
- B Musicians succeed only through formal training
- C Public performance prevents networking
- D Informal performance can become a serious career pathway